PATRICK J. MCLAUGHLIN, Ed.D.

EDUCATION EXECUTIVE | CURRICULUM, INSTRUCTION & SCHOOL IMPROVEMENT

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28 YEARS	24 YEARS	11 YEARS
Virginia public education	school & system leadership	central-office leadership

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Virginia public-school executive with 28 years in education and 24 years of school and system leadership, including eight years as a middle school principal, a one-year high school principal assignment, and 11 years in central-office leadership. Currently serves as Assistant Superintendent for Strategic Planning in Albemarle County Public Schools, a 14,000+ student division, with executive responsibility spanning strategic planning, assessment and accountability, program evaluation, school improvement, principal talent and supervision, instructional systems, policy and decision support, fiscal stewardship, and long-range planning. Brings a record of translating ambitious goals into coherent systems that strengthen teaching and learning, develop leaders, use evidence to guide improvement, align resources to priorities, and communicate clearly with staff, families, boards, and community partners.

CURRICULUM & INSTRUCTION • SCHOOL IMPROVEMENT • STRATEGIC PLANNING & ACCOUNTABILITY • PRINCIPAL & TALENT LEADERSHIP • PROGRAM EVALUATION • COMMUNITY & BOARD ENGAGEMENT

SELECTED EXECUTIVE IMPACT

- Led division work around the Bellwether instructional-practices audit and implementation of its recommendations, strengthening the connection among rigorous classroom tasks, adult learning, curricular resources, school planning, stakeholder engagement, pacing guides, and common quarterly assessments.
- Developed and implemented a targeted Transformation Schools Program for underperforming/federally identified schools, concentrating dedicated resources, bi-weekly leadership coaching, and data-driven planning. The work produced measurable gains in state performance measures, reduced absenteeism, and sustained progress in schools transitioning from intensive support.
- Directed the multi-year research, development, and community collaboration that produced Learning for All, Albemarle County Public Schools' strategic plan. The process began with a 112-member Portrait of a Learner design team, five design meetings, public forums, surveys, and School Board adoption.
- Provides principal and talent leadership through cabinet-level principal selection, evaluation of principals serving schools with the division's most significant academic-performance challenges, employee performance management, and leadership of a department with one of the division's highest Gallup engagement scores.
- Built Board-facing accountability and improvement systems including State of the Division reporting, policy and program evaluation, school-improvement monitoring, strategic-plan metrics, and data analysis used by executive leadership and the School Board to distinguish what is working from what needs to improve.
- Expanded executive responsibility into fiscal and operational stewardship through budget prioritization, employee health-care forecasting, twice-yearly ROI review of funded initiatives, capital-project prioritization, enrollment projections, staffing alignment, and leadership of a high-stakes redistricting process.

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP RANGE

INSTRUCTION & IMPROVEMENT	PEOPLE & CULTURE	STRATEGY & OPERATIONS
Curriculum, assessment, school improvement, program evaluation, professional learning, and evidence-based intervention.	Principal selection/evaluation, employee accountability, leadership coaching, high engagement, and collaborative team development.	Strategic planning, Board/community decision support, budgeting and ROI, capital planning, enrollment projections, and staffing alignment.

DIVISION-LEVEL EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP

ALBEMARLE COUNTY PUBLIC SCHOOLS | Charlottesville, Virginia | 2015-Present

Division context: more than 14,000 students across 726 square miles in rural, suburban, and urban communities.

Assistant Superintendent for Strategic Planning **July 2022-Present**

- Executive lead for Strategic Planning, Accountability & Research, and Program Evaluation; aligns school performance-improvement planning with division priorities and provides division and School Board decision support through data analysis, policy/program evaluation, State of the Division reporting, and facilitated work sessions.
- Provides principal talent leadership as a member of the cabinet-level principal hiring team that makes final principal-candidate recommendations to the superintendent; serves as principal evaluator for schools with the division's most challenging academic achievement issues; manages employee performance and disciplinary matters as a central supervisor. The department has one of the division's highest Gallup employee-engagement scores.
- Contributes to fiscal and operational stewardship through the ACPS Budget Advisory Committee; the joint local government-schools steering committee focused on multi-year employee health-care planning, provider options, cost increases, and budget projections; a Budget Initiative Review Team he founded to evaluate ROI twice yearly; enrollment projections used for school staffing; and prior Long-Range Planning Committee work on capital-project prioritization for School Board consideration.
- Leads assessment and accountability systems, including local/state/national testing support, assessment calendars and matrices, growth-score interpretation, school testing-coordinator resources, research review, and public performance reporting.
- Leads targeted school-improvement architecture, including Transformation Schools, multi-year support plans, principal/leadership coaching, 90-day planning cycles, instructional audit implementation, pacing/assessment alignment, and monitoring of evidence-based interventions for students.
- During the current improvement cycle, division chronic absenteeism declined from 17.7% in 2022-23 to 11.8% in 2024-25. In 2025-26, ACPS pass rates rose in reading, math, history, and writing; reading and math gains outpaced statewide gains, while the Black student reading gap narrowed by roughly five points. These are division wide results supported by a broad executive and instructional team.

Chief of Strategic Planning **July 2018-June 2022**

- Promoted to an executive-level role with direct supervision of Strategic Planning, Assessment & Accountability, Program Evaluation, and Strategic Communications; responsible for monitoring and adjusting division policy and leading the division Parent Council.
- Directed development of Learning for All and the Portrait of a Learner, engaging students, employees, families, community members, business leaders, service organizations, and higher-education partners in a shared vision for student success.
- Frequently led School Board breakout sessions on policy, student learning, and learning environments; provided accountability reporting and analysis designed to keep governance discussions grounded in evidence.
- Served concurrently as interim principal of Western Albemarle High School during the 2019-20 school year after an unexpected vacancy, while continuing division wide Chief responsibilities.

Strategic Planning Officer **July 2015-June 2018**

- Developed, implemented, and measured division strategic plans; advised, monitored, and provided feedback on school strategic-improvement plans across the division; co-led division leadership meetings, Strategic Cabinet, and Planning Cabinet.
- Provided oversight to school counseling, the division Program of Studies, and the EdLeader21 partnership; helped develop High School 2022/High School Redesign around Virginia’s Profile of a Graduate and personalized pathways.
- Evaluated and continuously improved major division systems, including Teacher Performance Appraisal and the learning-walk classroom-observation process.

SCHOOL LEADERSHIP & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Interim Principal | Western Albemarle High School **July 2019-June 2020**

- Accepted a one-year principal assignment following an unexpected June vacancy while simultaneously continuing as Chief of Strategic Planning, carrying school-level and division-level executive responsibilities at the same time.

Principal | Henley Middle School **July 2007-June 2015**

- Led Albemarle County Public Schools’ largest middle school for eight years before promotion to the division’s Strategic Planning Officer role.
- During his principal tenure, Henley received a Virginia Index of Performance (VIP) award for academic excellence.

Assistant Principal | Deep Run High School / Hermitage High School **2002-2007**

- Deep Run High School, July 2006-June 2007; Hermitage High School, July 2002-June 2006. Five years of high-school administrative experience across two school communities before moving into the principalship.

English Teacher | Hermitage High School **1998-2002**

- Taught standard and college-preparatory English 9 and English 11, including two years in a collaborative exceptional-education setting.

SELECTED LEADERSHIP INITIATIVES

LEARNING FOR ALL & PORTRAIT OF A LEARNER. Directed a multi-year strategic-planning process that intentionally linked community aspirations, student learning, system operations, and resource decisions. The 112-member design team represented teachers, support staff, principals, students, alumni, parents, business leaders, service organizations, and university partners; community forums and surveys broadened the feedback loop before Board adoption.

SELECTED SYSTEM LEADERSHIP PORTFOLIO - CONTINUED

SCHOOL IMPROVEMENT & 90-DAY CYCLES. Built a tiered improvement approach in which schools move from broad annual strategic plans to short-cycle priorities, leadership coaching, evidence checks, and targeted resource decisions. Transformation Schools concentrated that approach in schools with the greatest performance needs.

INSTRUCTIONAL PRACTICES AUDIT TO IMPLEMENTATION. Used an external Bellwether review to identify root causes behind persistent achievement disparities. Implementation work connected classroom rigor, professional learning/coaching, curricular resources, strategic alignment, stakeholder engagement, pacing guides, and assessment data rather than treating improvement as a single initiative.

HIGH SCHOOL REDESIGN & FRESHMAN SEMINAR. Helped reimagine the high school experience around Virginia's Profile of a Graduate, meaningful and relevant learning, student interests, career pathways, Program of Studies revisions, curriculum/assessment, and supports. Freshman Seminar was introduced as a relationship-centered advisory/course supporting social-emotional, academic, and career-development needs of ninth graders.

PROGRAM & POLICY EVALUATION. Created a dedicated Program Evaluation function to systematically assess program effectiveness and efficiency and contribute to continuous improvement. The function supports decisions tied to strategic goals, future planning, and the budget process and has examined instructional, policy, intervention, staffing, and operational programs.

COMMUNITY DECISION-MAKING & REDISTRICTING. Led processes designed to make public input consequential rather than ceremonial. In the Western Feeder Pattern redistricting, research, public meetings, survey data, and scenario revision created a transparent path from community feedback to committee recommendation.

GOVERNANCE, STAFF, COMMUNITY & RESOURCE LEADERSHIP

BOARD / GOVERNANCE. Experienced in recurring School Board-facing work on strategic planning, policy, student learning, accreditation/accountability, assessment, and performance reporting. Responsible in a prior executive role for monitoring and adjusting division policies; frequently facilitated Board breakout sessions and translated complex data into decision-ready information.

TALENT / PERSONNEL. Serves on the cabinet-level principal hiring team making final candidate recommendations to the superintendent and evaluates principals in schools with the most significant academic-performance challenges. Has managed employee performance and disciplinary matters as both a principal and central-office supervisor. Leads a department with one of the division's highest Gallup employee-engagement scores.

FISCAL / OPERATIONS. Serves on the Budget Advisory Committee and joint local government-schools steering committee for multi-year health-care planning, provider review, cost forecasting, and budget impact analysis. Founded the Budget Initiative Review Team to evaluate funded initiatives twice yearly for ROI and continuation decisions. Previously served on the Long-Range Planning Committee for capital prioritization and uses enrollment projections to inform school staffing.

COMMUNITY / COMMUNICATION. Led Parent Council, strategic-plan design teams, community forums, surveys, and redistricting engagement; directly supervised Strategic Communications as Chief of Strategic Planning. Uses structured listening, transparent rationale, and follow-through to mediate different perspectives and sustain trust.

EDUCATION

Doctor of Education (Ed.D.)	University of Virginia, Charlottesville, VA | Administration & Supervision | May 2007
Master of Teaching (M.T.)	University of Virginia, Charlottesville, VA | Secondary English Education certification | May 1998

EXECUTIVE DEVELOPMENT & PROFESSIONAL NETWORKS

- UVA Partnership for Leaders in Education (UVA-PLE), 2026
- AASA National Principal Supervisor Academy / principal-supervisor training, 2025-2026
- Data-Driven Instruction Seminar, 2024
- Virginia Tech Aspiring Superintendents Program, 2019
- Deeper Learning Leadership Forum, 2016-2018 - selected through a national nomination process for a 16-leader cohort focused on deeper learning, educational inequity, and leading systemic reform.
- EdLeader21 - division liaison to a national network supporting 21st-century education systems and the 4Cs: critical thinking, communication, collaboration, and creativity.